

"AI is bad, because AI steals water from people"

Posted by u/TVTropesPapermania • 0 points • 21 comments

I'm not well-informed about this type of the subject matter. But I feel a bit weirded out as to how AI is this openly hated.

For me, the only reason that could convince me to hate AI art, is when the art itself looks subjectively ugly for my taste, or when the artist is faking their drawing skills with AI.

If AI is not in those categories, then I'm perfectly neutral with how AI is used, and I won't delve into any intense arguments regarding AI.

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But recently, I've been hearing a new argument for why the "antis" (I think it's a bit of a stereotypical name) hate AI.

Thus bringing me to the title: Why are people suddenly using the environment as an excuse to bomb AI with vitriol hatred?

It just sounds so nonsensical to me, and I don't get the logic to be honest. The only logic I have is this:

- * To make Electricity and electronics you need WATER as a powersource.
- * Since AI is an electricity and an electronic. Of course you need water to fuel it.

The logic just sounds so simple. To create and make technology, water is highly likely going to be used as a powersource in some capacity.

Yet... I find it strange that because AI is powered by water, it's suddenly used as an excuse to hate AI. It even makes me feel like the environmental concerns are misplaced.

It's just easier to say: "Just use less electricity and power, so that you can save water".

Because I think AI fits into the same category as an electronic that is powered by water. AI to

be is like a sort of technology that's just another technology that needs water.

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I hope what I said here makes sense. Because while I think my stances on AI is overall neutral and I think the rage on it is too irrational to make sense beyond the surface level. My main conclusion is that using nature and environmental concerns to hate AI feels a bit too extreme for me to understand, because AI is still a piece of technology powered by water or other electrical science stuff.

To end it off, I wish that what I said here is a good expression of my opinion towards this specific argument being used against AI.

Comments

u/KurtCobijn • 2 points • 2025-10-29 19:03 UTC

The environmental effect of all data centers, only a fraction of which contain AI is not even in the same stratosphere as other industries that they support and patronize without scrutiny. The “AI is killing our environment/AI is polluting the water/AI is hogging the water supply/etc” is just a narrative that the anti-AI crowd are clinging to in order to drum up support for their cause, ignoring the fact that the data just doesn't support their wild claims, and hoping that people don't do their own research and just hop on the bandwagon and parrot said claims.

u/TVTropesPapermania • 1 points • 2025-10-30 00:58 UTC

Pretty much yeah. I can't see the difference between a typical AI generator needing water, and a normal computer, ipad, and iphone literally needing the exact same water in order to just build its components.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-10-27 04:25 UTC

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u/raviteja777 • 2 points • 2025-10-25 01:15 UTC

Oil paints , acrylic paints may use some synthetic pigments and chemicals , which have environmental concerns too.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-10-24 23:58 UTC

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u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-10-24 23:13 UTC

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u/Fakeitforreddit • 2 points • 2025-10-24 20:51 UTC

You lost me at "hating art something because you dont like the art".

That's an insane stance to HATE something because its not to your taste.

u/TVTropesPapermania • 1 points • 2025-10-24 21:33 UTC

I don't hate AI art in general. More specifically, I hate certain AI Art that has a sort of "3d style" that appears uncanny and mass-produced. The sort of AI art that's basically used in content farm channels and then creates very cheap sob stories.

Besides those types of AI arts on Youtube. The AI arts posted here are pretty decent and I like them, as a contrast to the I would say, "lower quality content produced by AI".

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-10-24 19:22 UTC

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u/Signal_Confusion_644 • 2 points • 2025-10-24 19:15 UTC

Agree in almost all your points. But you are looking bad AI art because the slop is everywhere. Too many bots posting shit. If you are in the open source AI circles, the quality just jumps to astronomical levels. And shit go Wild.

People do really amazing things that you Will never see because the feed and the algorithm.

u/TVTropesPapermania • 3 points • 2025-10-24 19:18 UTC

I see your point. I'm overall fine with AI art, as long as it looks pretty to look at.

I just find it annoying that when I'm just randomly scrolling, I find so much ugly 3d AI art being used as thumbnails or being placed inside of a YouTube voice, all while there is a generic narration.

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It's nice to see that you know of some high-quality AI content as a vast contrast to the low AI slop content I just stumble across and would rather not look at.

u/Signal_Confusion_644 • 5 points • 2025-10-24 19:30 UTC

I completely understand your frustration. As someone who identifies as "ProAI" but also as a traditional and digital artist, I'm also really bothered by everyone hopping on the AI trend just to create absolute junk that's killing everyone's feed.

But... believe me, I've seen this cycle before, back during the rise of Photoshop and the beginning of social media (i perfectly remember all those bad, low-effort memes cycling endlessly in my screen) It's the same pattern with every new trend, and it's... Boring.

But there's another perspective here that most people outside the core AI generation scene don't often see: for those of us actively working and playing around with it, we still view it as "experimental" and miles away from the quality standard we are trying to reach. We are ****NEVER**** fully satisfied with the outputs.

When these images get shared on our networks, it's usually more like a... showing off what we can do with this faulty thing, rather than artistic pride.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-10-25 08:37 UTC

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u/TVTropesPapermania • 2 points • 2025-10-24 21:38 UTC

Thank you for saying this. I'm definitely on the neutral side of AI art, and whenever I see social media posts tearing down companies all because of "they use AI art, so by definition the company is very bad".

I just cringe and I don't even watch those types of videos. To me, I think the hate on AI art sounds pretty much like Ragebait. Basically, I think people only hate AI art because it's trendy to hate it, without actually understanding a more surface reason beyond the hate.

By the way, I didn't even know photoshop was hated before. I just didn't pay that much attention to photoshop.

Anyways, this is a well-written commentary you made on social media. Because in the end, I totally agree that AI art is getting way too much hate and I dislike videos that dogpile trash on Art, and the only reason it's hated is due to the origin being AI, instead of the actual drawing quality in itself.

u/RobertD3277 • 4 points • 2025-10-24 19:12 UTC

The reasons they give for this nonsense could easily be applied to gaming machines, large data centers, cloud servers, and just about anything else that requires a significant amount of CPU processing power.

The same arguments can also be made about the entire movie industry and the level of destruction throughout the history of the movie industry in the process of making movies. That doesn't even get into the toxic materials that went into the makeups and paints and other things to transform actors and actresses into whatever character is needed.

It's just another useless metric these uneducated idiots think they have That means absolutely nothing in the real world when they take a look at the wastefulness of their own pathetic lives. Nothing more than rage bait and something to be ignored.

That's not to say that there might not be a legitimate argument If you take into account gaming machines that require high-powered GPUs or any other large level mathematical computation process that uses the same level of large processing systems, IE cloud servers. There is a legitimate discussion about power requirements in that level but do single out AI as a single end of existence criteria is ludicrous at best and quite blatantly a lie at worst.

u/TVTropesPapermania • 2 points • 2025-10-24 19:15 UTC

I agree. Literally water is used everywhere for so much of technology.

AI too is technology. So AI using water and it being treated as a bad thing is a logic that should be applied to every electronic-based gadget that needs waster.

So with that, I think the environmental concerns being utilized to hate AI feels like an illogical double standard. When basically overall tech and electrical usage is linked to water.

u/RobertD3277 • 3 points • 2025-10-24 19:18 UTC

The one thing I missed or forgot to put in the above response is that AI itself including AI data centers have been estimated to only take up 2% of the so-called workload of the GPU framework. The thing about the usage of water is it's not really destroyed since evaporation condensation and other factors of it returning back into the genuine water supply are all factually proven.

If there is a real world case for water being destroyed, it's the water being used to cool a nuclear power plant, becoming radioactive, or water used in fracking, becoming toxically polluted with chemicals. Again legitimate discussions but this isn't about legitimate discussions and it never was.

u/DarwinOGF • 1 points • 2025-10-24 21:15 UTC

Actually, water itself is unable to become radioactive! It can be polluted by radioactive material, but on itself, only tritium water is radioactive, and it is extremely rare and cannot be reliably manufactured.

But regular water itself - no, straight-up impossible outside of a fusion/fission reaction.

u/TVTropesPapermania • 2 points • 2025-10-24 19:20 UTC

Thanks for giving more clarifications and information on the topic of water's application into technology. But I believe these types of information are starting to overwhelm what it is I could understand.

Still, it's nice you know so much of how the water cycle works when applied to technology.

u/RobertD3277 • 3 points • 2025-10-24 19:23 UTC

You can do lookups and find videos on YouTube that talks about water cooling systems in a wide range of applications. It's a very old and well-known technology that significantly predates any thinking of artificial intelligence in the modern context. For that matter you could even find some people using water-cooled techniques, beyond the radiator, and automobiles that goes back decades.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-10-24 18:59 UTC

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u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-10-24 18:45 UTC

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u/Gargantuanman91 • 14 points • 2025-10-24 18:43 UTC

Water as a power source isn't pollutive, most people mix a lot of things, data centers (as well as some gaming pcs) use water (not actually potable water) as coolant but in close loop systems (not as a continuous stream).

What happens after water is used? well Antoine Lavoisier in 1785 stated that matter is neither created nor destroyed, even if water is used or "Wasted" water return to the soil or the atmosphere to return into the water cycle.

That doesn't mean AI or data centers don't use a lot of energy (electric power) but many industries and things also, that's not inherent something bad, just in a transition to the optimal usage.

So you can research about around this ideas to make up your mind.

u/TVTropesPapermania • 6 points • 2025-10-24 18:48 UTC

Thanks for giving an explanation to how water is utilized around technology.